

XINGTIAN (JAMES) SI

Chicago, IL | xingtian@uchicago.edu | +1 (872)-378-6686 | xingtiansi.github.io

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Chicago, IL <i>M.A. in Economics</i>	09/2026 – 06/2027
University of Nottingham Ningbo China, Ningbo, China <i>B.Sc. Economics (dual degree with the University of Nottingham, UK)</i> GPA: 3.90/4.0; Rank: Top 5%; First-Class Honours Awards: Provost's Scholarship for Academic Excellence (Top 5%), Jan 2025 & Dec 2025 Zhejiang Provincial Scholarship, Oct 2025 UNNC Award for Outstanding Students (UG), May 2026 Zhejiang Excellent Graduate, May 2026	09/2022 – 07/2026
University of Nottingham, Nottingham, UK <i>B.Sc. Economics GPA: 4.0/4.0</i>	09/2024 – 01/2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Correspondence Audit Studies on Labor Market Discrimination <i>Research Assistant, Supervised by Prof. Sally Sadoff (University of California, San Diego)</i> - Used Python to process participant-level data from 10,000+ respondents (44,000+ observations) across 8 name-perception studies, constructing race and gender perception accuracy measures in an analysis-ready one-row-per-participant format - Constructed a structured 53-sheet database tracing the provenance of 600+ fictitious names across 22 correspondence audit studies, verifying each source against original paper appendices	05/2026 – Present
Estimating HTE of Early Childhood Interventions on Fifth-Grade Math Achievement <i>Research Assistant, Supervised by Dr. Jiayi Yang (Columbia University)</i> - Extracted and merged longitudinal ECLS-K:2011 data ($n \approx 18,000$) using Python (pandas) and R (tidyverse), applying sample weights and multiple imputation (MICE) to handle missing values - Trained causal random forests (R grf) to estimate heterogeneous treatment effects of early childhood interventions, identifying an approximately 0.15 SD improvement in fifth-grade math scores among high-risk children	03/2025 – 09/2025
Board Gender Diversity and Firm Performance in the UK <i>Research Assistant, Supervised by Prof. Abigail Barr (University of Nottingham)</i> - Estimated linear and nonlinear panel models on 840 firm-year observations (2008–2016) using Stata, with board-size, year, and industry fixed effects; tested for heteroskedasticity (White test) and moderation via firm-size interactions - Identified an inverted-U relationship between female director share and Tobin's Q (threshold around 20–25%), moderated by firm size; findings published as a co-authored paper in Entrepreneurship and Innovation	11/2024 – 06/2025
Causal Machine Learning and Counterfactual Inference in Consumer Behavior <i>Undergraduate Dissertation, Supervised by Prof. Zhenjiang Lin (University of Nottingham Ningbo China)</i> - Applied causal machine learning methods (causal random forests, TMLE, BART) in R (grf, tmle) and Python (scikit-learn) to estimate average and heterogeneous treatment effects of coupon and advertising interventions on consumer behavior - Analyzed e-commerce clickstream and purchase data with SQL and Python, using MICE for missing values; designed a personalized coupon allocation framework with dashboards (R Shiny) to support targeting decisions under budget constraints	09/2025 – 04/2026
When Click-to-Cancel Creates Complexity: A Theory of Subscription Regulation <i>Independent Research, University of Nottingham Ningbo China</i> - Developed a partial-equilibrium model in which firms jointly choose cancellation friction and retention-menu complexity; proved a "waterbed effect" whereby capping friction under California's AB 2863 raises firms' return to complexity - Derived the welfare condition under which click-to-cancel regulation benefits consumers, showing that only comprehensive regulation constraining both instruments eliminates the waterbed effect	03/2026 – Present

PUBLICATIONS

Si, X. (2026). *Causal Effects of Coupon Expiration on Consumer Acceptance: Evidence from Conditional Heterogeneous Treatment Effects*. Submitted to Applied Economics.

Si, X. (2025). *Estimating Heterogeneous Treatment Effects of Early Childhood Interventions on Fifth-Grade Math Achievement: A Machine Learning-Augmented Causal Analysis of ECLS-K:2011*. International Journal of Intelligence Science, 15, 145–161.

Si, X., Lin, K., Yang, X., & Wen, Z. (2025). *Board Gender Diversity on Firm Performance in the UK: Evidence of Non-linear Returns and Firm Size Moderation (2008–2016)*. Entrepreneurship and Innovation, 9(4), 141–145.

Si, X., Fang, C., Xie, W. *When Click-to-Cancel Creates Complexity: A Theory of Subscription Regulation*. Working Paper.

SKILLS

Programming: Python (pandas, numpy, scikit-learn), R (tidyverse, grf, tmle), Stata, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX
Methods: Causal machine learning (CRF, TMLE, BART); panel data; time series; dashboarding (R Shiny, Python Dash)